# RAJASTHAN ROYALS – IPL 2026 AUCTION STRATEGY

**Submission for SupeRR Selector Hackathon**

**VISHNU C**

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# 1. RAHUL CHAHAR (Lead Indian Spinner)

**Player Summary (Bio):**
Rahul Chahar is a 26-year-old leg-spinner known for drift, pace variation, and disciplined middle-overs control. A key contributor to Mumbai Indians' championship campaigns, he brings high-pressure experience and wicket-taking ability. His domestic performances remain consistent across formats.

**Why RR Needs Him:**
RR lack a frontline Indian spinner after recent releases. Chahar fills the core tactical requirement of a reliable middle-overs wicket-taker who can partner Jadeja and restrict scoring.

**Stats Panel:**

- **IPL:** 75 wickets, Econ 7.7, SR 22
- **T20:** 136 wickets, Econ 7.5
- **Domestic:** Strong List-A + FC performance

| Player Name | Bowling Type | Nationality | Economy | Wickets | Overs |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Ravi Bishnoi | Right-arm Leg-Break | India | 8.02 | 142 | 435.60 |
| Rahul Chahar | Right-arm Leg-Break | India | 8.00 | 72 | 268.50 |
| Murugan Ashwin | Right-arm Leg-Break | India | 7.67 | 58 | 202.90 |
| Sandeep Warrier | Right-arm medium | India | 8.13 | 54 | 195.80 |
| Krishnappa Gowtham | Right-arm offbreak | India | 7.90 | 59 | 194.00 |
| KC Cariappa | Right-arm Leg-Break | India | 6.95 | 49 | 189.60 |
| Shubhang Hegde | Slow left-arm orthodox | India | 7.04 | 57 | 180.60 |
| Lalit Yadav | Right-arm offbreak | India | 8.60 | 46 | 172.20 |
| R Sonu Yadav | Right-arm medium-fast | India | 7.90 | 65 | 165.50 |
| Siddarth Kaul | Right-arm medium | India | 8.13 | 54 | 157.30 |
| Karn Sharma | Right-arm Leg-Break | India | 9.30 | 43 | 150.60 |
| Chetan Sakariya | Left-arm medium-fast | India | 8.15 | 49 | 148.60 |
| Shivam Mavi | Right-arm Fast | India | 9.25 | 60 | 145.00 |
| Kumar Kartikeya Singh | Slow left-arm orthodox | India | 7.95 | 48 | 143.60 |
| Prashant Solanki | Right-arm Leg-Break | India | 9.36 | 52 | 136.40 |
| Shiva Singh | Slow left-arm orthodox | India | 6.73 | 23 | 130.10 |

**Note**: Rajasthan Royals currently lack a frontline, strike-rate-suppressing Indian spinner. Our primary target should be **Ravi Bishnoi**, a proven T20 specialist with elite control in the middle overs and excellent performance under pressure. We will remain active in the bidding until **₹7 Cr**. However, teams like **CSK**, who have a strong purse and a clear need for an Indian spinner, may push the price significantly.

If the bidding exceeds our limit, the sensible fallback is **Rahul Chahar**, who offers comparable value at a lower competitive intensity. His IPL experience across multiple franchises, reliable economy, and leg-spin variation make him a strong asset. Securing either Bishnoi or Chahar immediately resolves our key bowling gap.

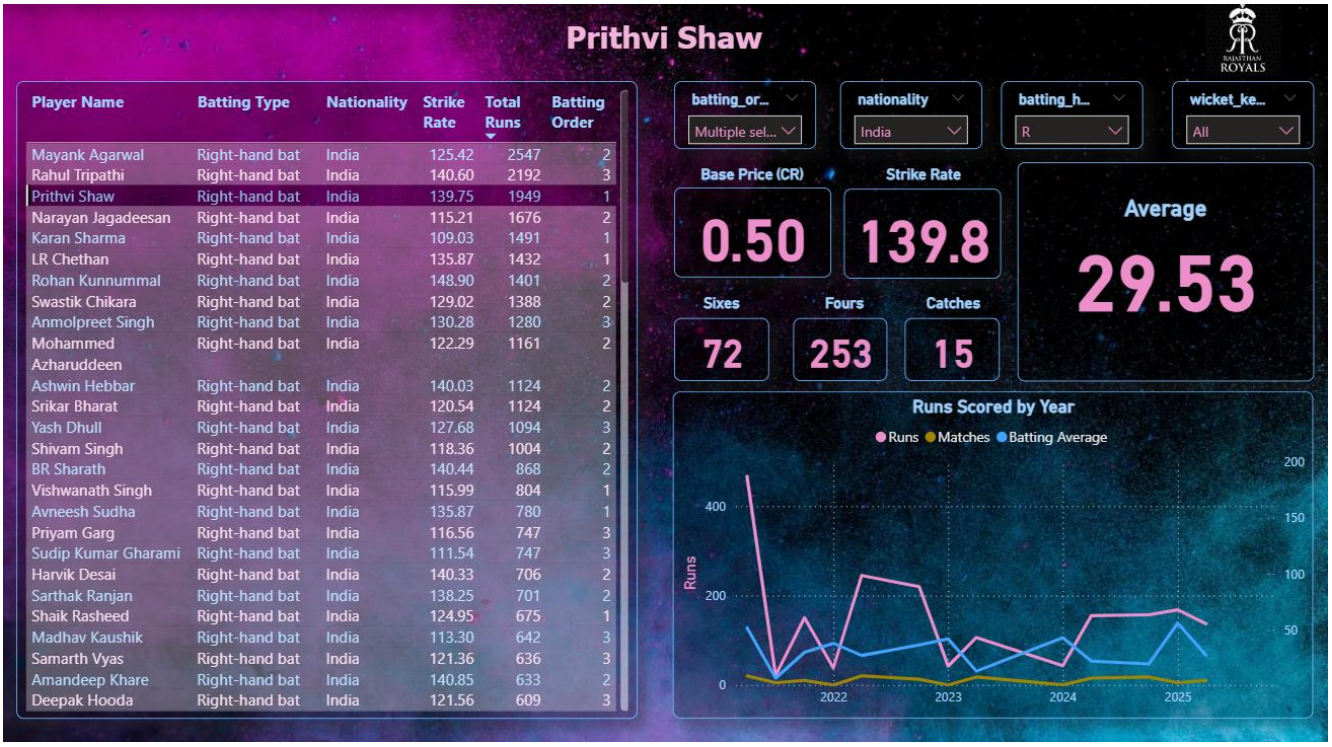
# 2. PRITHVI SHAW (Top-Order Indian Batter)

**Player Summary (Bio):**
Prithvi Shaw is an explosive right-hand opener with an IPL strike rate above 145 and a history of fast starts in the powerplay. Recently returning to form in domestic cricket, he brings aggression, experience, and the ability to counter left-arm pace early.

**Why RR Needs Him:**
RR's top order is currently dominated by left-handers (Jaiswal, Vaibhav) and lacks an experienced right-hand aggressor. Shaw balances the lineup and strengthens the top three.

**Stats Panel:**

- **IPL:** 1892 runs, SR 147
- **T20:** 2900+ runs, SR 151
- **FC recent:** 222, 75, 71 (excellent form)




| Player Name | Batting Type | Nationality | Strike Rate | Total Runs | Batting Order |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Mayank Agarwal | Right-hand bat | India | 125.42 | 2547 | 2 |
| Rahul Tripathi | Right-hand bat | India | 140.60 | 2192 | 3 |
| Prithvi Shaw | Right-hand bat | India | 139.75 | 1949 | 1 |
| Narayan Jagadeesan | Right-hand bat | India | 115.21 | 1676 | 2 |
| Karan Sharma | Right-hand bat | India | 109.03 | 1491 | 1 |
| LR Chethan | Right-hand bat | India | 135.87 | 1432 | 1 |
| Rohan Kunnummal | Right-hand bat | India | 148.90 | 1401 | 2 |
| Swastik Chikara | Right-hand bat | India | 129.02 | 1388 | 2 |
| Anmolpreet Singh | Right-hand bat | India | 130.28 | 1280 | 3 |
| Mohammed Azharuddeen | Right-hand bat | India | 122.29 | 1161 | 2 |
| Ashwin Hebbar | Right-hand bat | India | 140.03 | 1124 | 2 |
| Srikar Bharat | Right-hand bat | India | 120.54 | 1124 | 2 |
| Yash Dhull | Right-hand bat | India | 127.68 | 1094 | 3 |
| Shivam Singh | Right-hand bat | India | 118.36 | 1004 | 2 |
| BR Sharath | Right-hand bat | India | 140.44 | 868 | 2 |
| Vishwanath Singh | Right-hand bat | India | 115.99 | 804 | 1 |
| Avneesh Sudha | Right-hand bat | India | 135.87 | 780 | 1 |
| Priyam Garg | Right-hand bat | India | 116.56 | 747 | 3 |
| Sudip Kumar Gharami | Right-hand bat | India | 111.54 | 747 | 3 |
| Harvik Desai | Right-hand bat | India | 140.33 | 706 | 2 |
| Sarthak Ranjan | Right-hand bat | India | 138.25 | 701 | 2 |
| Shaik Rasheed | Right-hand bat | India | 124.95 | 675 | 1 |
| Madhav Kaushik | Right-hand bat | India | 113.30 | 642 | 3 |
| Samarth Vyas | Right-hand bat | India | 121.36 | 636 | 3 |
| Amandeep Khare | Right-hand bat | India | 140.85 | 633 | 2 |
| Deepak Hooda | Right-hand bat | India | 121.56 | 609 | 3 |

**Note**: RR's top order is heavily left-handed and needs an experienced right-hand stabilizer. Prithvi Shaw provides explosive starts, proven IPL success, and recent strong domestic form—bringing much-needed right-hand balance alongside Jaiswal and Vaibhav. We will pursue Shaw up to **₹5 Cr** for his high-impact value. If bidding exceeds this limit, **Rahul Tripathi** becomes the ideal alternative, offering consistency, versatility in the top 3, and dependable performances under pressure at a more cost-effective price.

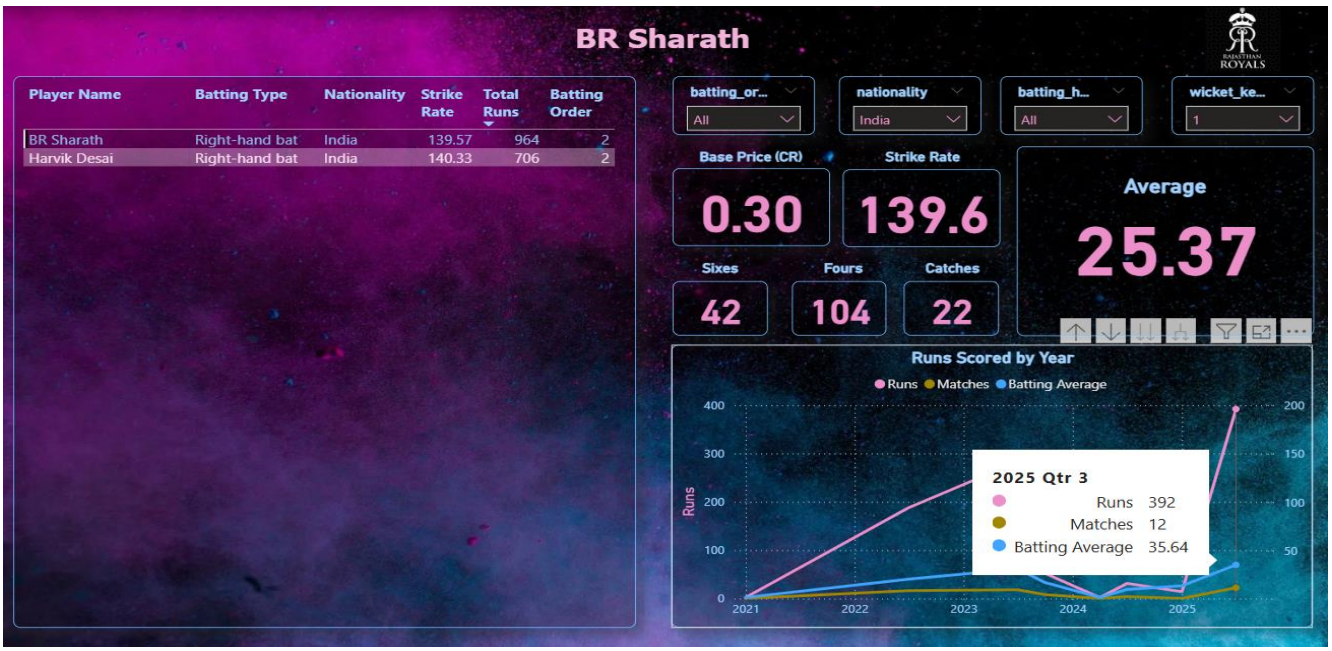
# 3. BR SHARATH (Backup Indian WK)

**Player Summary (Bio):**
BR Sharath is a technically solid right-hand wicketkeeper-batter with consistent List A and T20 records for Karnataka. His keeping is tidy, and he has shown improved temperament in pressure chases.

**Why RR Needs Him:**
RR currently have only Dhruv Jurel as a specialist Indian keeper. Sharath provides essential bench depth, allowing tactical rotations without burning overseas slots.

**Stats Panel:**

- **List A Avg:** 30.5
- **T20 SR:** 117
- Very reliable keeper (20 catches, 9 stumpings in T20)




| match_id | player_id | player_name | match_date | batting_order | Dismissal_Status | runs_scored | balls_faced | strike_rate | no_of_sixes | no_of_fours |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 40905 | 4486 | BR Sharath | 05 March 2025 | 1 | 1 | 14 | 16 | 87.5 | 0 | 2 |
| 45305 | 4486 | BR Sharath | 13 August 2025 | 2 | 1 | 70 | 31 | 225.81 | 5 | 7 |
| 45333 | 4486 | BR Sharath | 28 August 2025 | 2 | 1 | 49 | 35 | 140 | 3 | 4 |
| 45320 | 4486 | BR Sharath | 21 August 2025 | 2 | 1 | 25 | 16 | 156.25 | 2 | 2 |
| 45320 | 4486 | BR Sharath | 17 August 2025 | 2 | 1 | 45 | 22 | 204.55 | 2 | 6 |
| 45332 | 4486 | BR Sharath | 27 August 2025 | 2 | 1 | 43 | 21 | 204.76 | 2 | 6 |
| 45329 | 4486 | BR Sharath | 25 August 2025 | 2 | 1 | 19 | 15 | 126.67 | 2 | 1 |
| 45323 | 4486 | BR Sharath | 22 August 2025 | 2 | 1 | 28 | 16 | 175 | 2 | 3 |
| 45317 | 4486 | BR Sharath | 19 August 2025 | 2 | 1 | 22 | 13 | 169.23 | 1 | 3 |
| 45326 | 4486 | BR Sharath | 24 August 2025 | 2 | 2 | 72 | 47 | 153.19 | 1 | 9 |
| 45300 | 4486 | BR Sharath | 11 August 2025 | 2 | 1 | 16 | 14 | 114.29 | 1 | 1 |
| 45309 | 4486 | BR Sharath | 15 August 2025 | 2 | 1 | 2 | 2 | 100 | 0 | 0 |
| 45330 | 4486 | BR Sharath | 26 August 2025 | 2 | 1 | 1 | 3 | 33.33 | 0 | 0 |

**Note**: With RR relying solely on **Dhruv Jurel** as the primary Indian wicketkeeper, acquiring a reliable backup is essential.
BR Sharath has shown strong domestic consistency, improved strike rate, and stability behind the stumps. Teams like **KKR**, who are thin on Indian keeping options, may also target him. His profile fits perfectly into the “dependable backup keeper” role without significant purse impact.

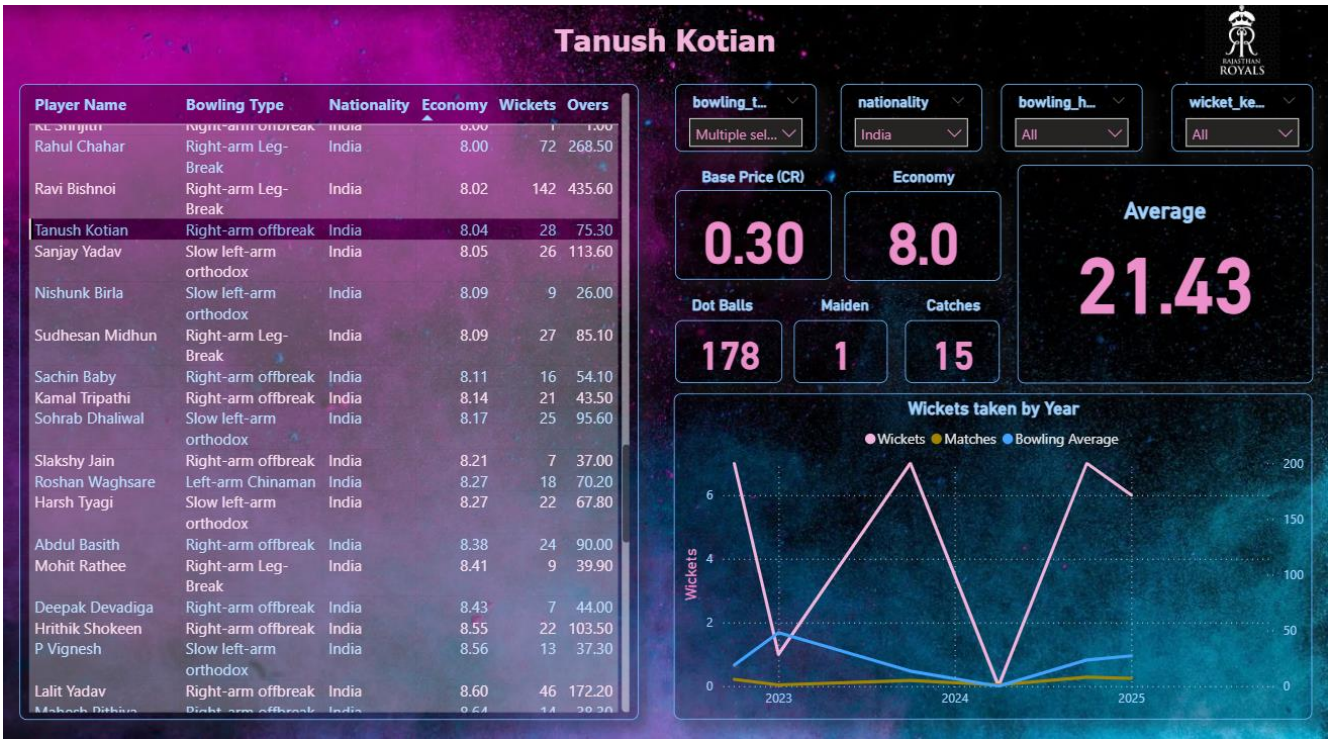
# 4. TANUSH KOTIAN (Backup Indian Spinner)

**Player Summary (Bio):**
Tanush Kotian is a high-value domestic all-rounder with exceptional first-class performances for Mumbai. A reliable off-spinner and gritty lower-order batter, he has recently shown strong T20 economy and wicket-taking potential.

**Why RR Needs Him:**
Most teams will chase overseas spinners. RR can secure a quality Indian spin all-rounder affordably to back up Jadeja and Chahar/Bishnoi, adding depth to spin and batting.

**Stats Panel:**

- **Recent:** multiple 4-wicket hauls
- **T20 Econ:** 6.39 (excellent)
- **FC Bat Avg:** 42(high-value allrounder)




| Player Name | Bowling Type | Nationality | Economy | Wickets | Overs |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Rahul Chahar | Right-arm Leg-Break | India | 8.00 | 72 | 268.50 |
| Ravi Bishnoi | Right-arm Leg-Break | India | 8.02 | 142 | 435.60 |
| Tanush Kotian | Right-arm offbreak | India | 8.04 | 28 | 75.30 |
| Sanjay Yadav | Slow left-arm orthodox | India | 8.05 | 26 | 113.60 |
| Nishunk Birla | Slow left-arm orthodox | India | 8.09 | 9 | 26.00 |
| Sudhesan Midhun | Right-arm Leg-Break | India | 8.09 | 27 | 85.10 |
| Sachin Baby | Right-arm offbreak | India | 8.11 | 16 | 54.10 |
| Kamal Tripathi | Right-arm offbreak | India | 8.14 | 21 | 43.50 |
| Sohrab Dhaliwal | Slow left-arm orthodox | India | 8.17 | 25 | 95.60 |
| Slakshy Jain | Right-arm offbreak | India | 8.21 | 7 | 37.00 |
| Roshan Waghsare | Left-arm Chinaman | India | 8.27 | 18 | 70.20 |
| Harsh Tyagi | Slow left-arm orthodox | India | 8.27 | 22 | 67.80 |
| Abdul Basith | Right-arm offbreak | India | 8.38 | 24 | 90.00 |
| Mohit Rathee | Right-arm Leg-Break | India | 8.41 | 9 | 39.90 |
| Deepak Devadiga | Right-arm offbreak | India | 8.43 | 7 | 44.00 |
| Hrithik Shokeen | Right-arm offbreak | India | 8.55 | 22 | 103.50 |
| P Vignesh | Slow left-arm orthodox | India | 8.56 | 13 | 37.30 |
| Lalit Yadav | Right-arm offbreak | India | 8.60 | 46 | 172.20 |

**Note**: Most franchises will prioritize overseas spinners in the auction. This gives RR a strategic advantage in targeting domestic spin all-rounders.

**Tanush Kotian** has delivered excellent first-class performances, contributes meaningfully with both bat and ball, and has recently shown impactful T20 form. With Jadeja and Chahar/Bishnoi leading the spin attack, Kotian becomes the ideal rotational option to fortify depth while strengthening the lower middle order.

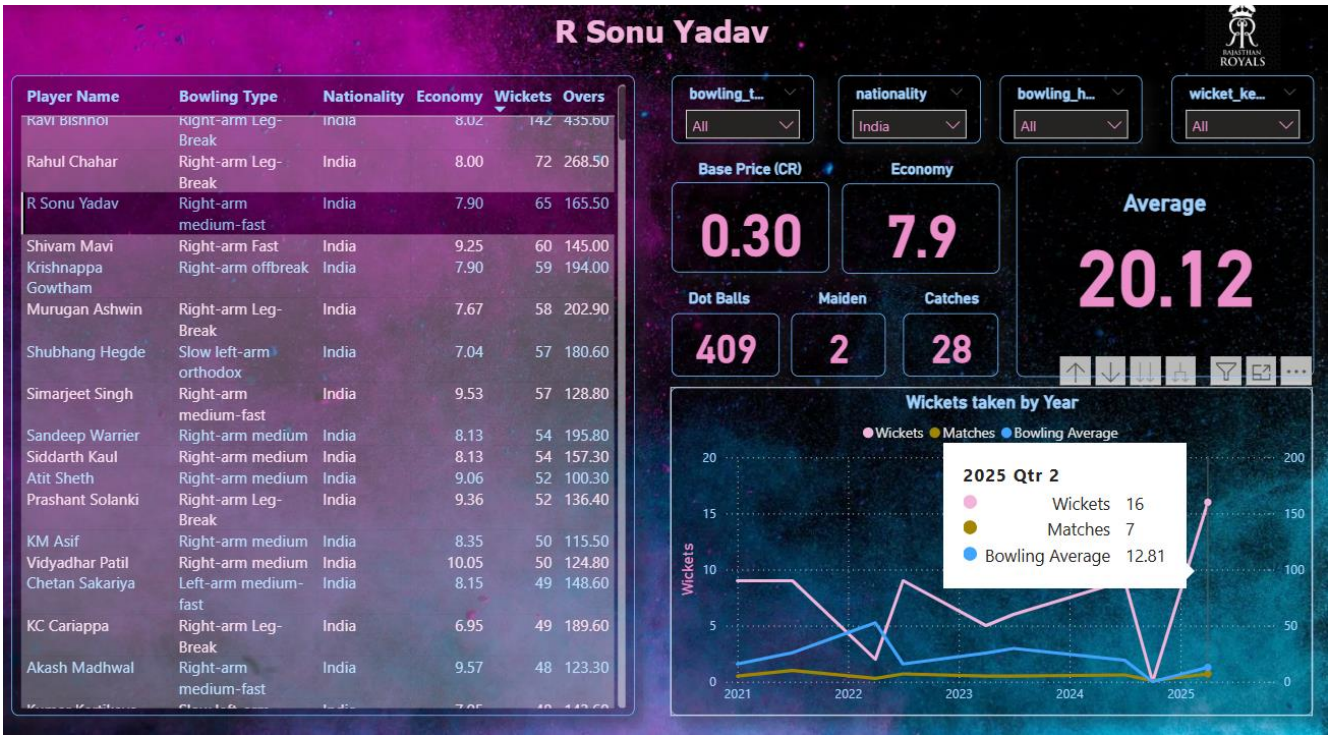
# 5. R SONU YADAV (Young Indian Fast Bowler)

**Player Summary (Bio):**
Sonu Yadav is a 26-year-old right-arm medium-fast bowler showing strong recent performances in domestic cricket and the TNPL. He offers improving pace, death-over potential, and the ability to swing the ball early.

**Why RR Needs Him:**
RR's pace attack has injury and consistency risks—Archer (fitness), Sandeep (aging), Deshpande (expensive). Sonu provides a future-ready Indian pace option with upside.

**Stats Panel:**

- **T20 Bowling:** 9 wickets in 6 matches, Econ 7.2
- **FC:** Avg 25 with ball
- Known for finishing overs




**Note:** RR's fast-bowling group has certain vulnerabilities:

- Sandeep Sharma is aging
- Tushar Deshpande can be expensive at the death
- Jofra Archer is injury-prone
- Yudhvir needs a strong domestic partner

**Sonu Yadav** has displayed notable improvements in pace, control, and wicket-taking ability. His recent form across formats indicates he can grow into a dependable backup seamer and contribute during rotation-heavy phases of the season.

# 6. MOEEN ALI (Overseas Allrounder Spinner)

**Player Summary (Bio):**
Moeen Ali is a seasoned batting all-rounder with global T20 experience across IPL, PSL, BPL, and The Hundred. A left-hand middle-order hitter and dependable off-spinner, he offers leadership, flexibility, and matchup advantage against left-hand batters.

**Why RR Needs Him:**
RR have only **one overseas slot** left. Moeen brings part-time spin, batting depth, and tactical experience alongside Jadeja and Sam Curran. If RR secure Bishnoi and Kotian, Moeen becomes the perfect value pick..

**Stats Panel:**

- **IPL:** 1167 runs, SR 139
- **41 wickets, Econ 7.2**
- Excellent spin-hitting + off-spin versatility

| Player Name | Bowling Type | Nationality | Economy | Wickets | Overs |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Wanindu Hasaranga | Right-arm Leg-Break | Sri Lanka | 7.16 | 286 | 696.90 |
| Akeal Hosein | Slow left-arm orthodox | West Indies | 7.40 | 213 | 733.50 |
| Adam Zampa | Right-arm Leg-Break | Australia | 7.68 | 197 | 555.60 |
| Maheesh Theekshana | Right-arm offbreak | Sri Lanka | 7.20 | 182 | 671.10 |
| Mujeeb Ur Rahman | Right-arm offbreak | Afghanistan | 7.11 | 171 | 557.80 |
| Chris Green | Right-arm offbreak | Australia | 7.50 | 160 | 570.80 |
| Moeen Ali | Right-arm offbreak | England | 8.22 | 142 | 429.80 |
| Gudakesh Moti-Kanhai | Slow left-arm orthodox | West Indies | 8.13 | 111 | 321.60 |
| Sikandar Raza | Right-arm offbreak | Zimbabwe | 8.04 | 108 | 442.60 |
| Mohammad Rishad Hossain | Right-arm Leg-Break | Bangladesh | 8.67 | 97 | 240.70 |
| Liam Livingstone | Right-arm Leg-Break | England | 9.62 | 85 | 290.80 |
| Waqar Salamkheil | Left-arm Chinaman | Afghanistan | 8.27 | 84 | 221.90 |
| Glenn Maxwell | Right-arm offbreak | Australia | 8.58 | 82 | 299.90 |
| Roston Chase | Right-arm offbreak | West Indies | 7.90 | 78 | 267.10 |
| Dan Mousley | Right-arm offbreak | England | 7.71 | 65 | 181.80 |
| Michael Bracewell | Right-arm offbreak | New Zealand | 9.14 | 54 | 171.60 |
| Matthew Short | Right-arm offbreak | Australia | 8.29 | 48 | 170.70 |
| Dunith Wellalage | Slow left-arm orthodox | Sri Lanka | 7.39 | 47 | 155.20 |
| Dan Lawrence | Right-arm offbreak | England | 8.70 | 30 | 79.00 |

**Note:** RR has only **one overseas slot** available, making versatility a priority.
**Moeen Ali** offers invaluable experience, batting power in the middle order, leadership depth, and quality off-spin—perfect to complement Jadeja and a leg-spinner. His familiarity with Curran and Jadeja's playing style further strengthens team chemistry.
Given his age, competition will be moderate, and acquiring him around **₹2 Cr** is realistic.

If RR successfully secures Bishnoi and Kotian, leaving some purse flexibility, a base-price bid on **Faf du Plessis** also becomes viable for a leadership boost and top-order solidity.

# CONCLUSION & FINAL AUCTION SUMMARY

1. **Rahul Chahar – Max Bid: ₹6.5 Cr**
   A proven Indian leg-spinner with strong IPL pedigree. If RR fails to secure Ravi Bishnoi (primary target, cap at ₹7 Cr), Rahul becomes the ideal fit due to lower competition and tactical value on Indian pitches.

2. **Prithvi Shaw – Max Bid: ₹5 Cr**
   A high-strike-rate Indian opener who adds right-hand balance to RR's left-heavy top order. If bidding exceeds ₹5 Cr, RR should pivot to **Rahul Tripathi** as the alternative anchor.

3. **BR Sharath – Max Bid: ₹1 Cr**
   A reliable domestic wicketkeeper-batter in good recent form. RR requires an Indian backup keeper for Dhruv Jurel, and supply in the auction is limited.

4. **Tanush Kotian – Max Bid: ₹1 Cr**
   A developing off-spinner and lower-order contributor. He provides depth behind Jadeja and the lead spinner (Chahar/Bishnoi), especially valuable on tired pitches.

5. **Sonu Yadav – Max Bid: ₹0.5 Cr**
   A young Indian medium-fast bowler who has shown control and wicket-taking ability. RR needs depth in domestic pace to protect against Archer's injury risks and the inconsistency of Deshpande/Sandeep.

6. **Moeen Ali – Max Bid: ₹2 Cr**
   An experienced overseas batting all-rounder who brings part-time offspin, tactical maturity, and flexibility at No. 4–7.
   If RR secures both **Bishnoi + Kotian**, they may alternatively pursue **Faf du Plessis** at base price for leadership and top-order stability.

- **Spin Department Strengthened:** One lead spinner (Bishnoi/Chahar) + Kotian + Jadeja provides elite variety and control.
- **Top-Order Stability:** Shaw/Tripathi gives an experienced right-hander to complement Jaiswal and Vaibhav.
- **Pace Depth Improved:** Sonu Yadav + Yudhvir buffer the workload of Archer and Deshpande.
- **Middle-Order Options:** Moeen supports Parag, Hetmyer, Jurel, and Ferreira with flexibility and spin value.
- **Balanced Squad Composition:** RR meets the required mix of Indian core, backup options, and a smart final overseas selection.

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I created the dashboards using **Power BI**, cleaned and shaped the datasets using **SQL**, and compiled this team strategy based on statistical performance, auction tendencies, and squad requirements. Since I registered shortly before the competition deadline, I focused on essential data sources including **ESPNcricinfo** and the available player dataset to deliver a complete, actionable strategic analysis for the auction.